



Budget Phone (Under ₹20,000)

Where affordability meets surprisingly good performance.

Budget phones in 2025 have evolved far beyond the basics. This segment now delivers smooth performance, reliable battery life, and cameras that punch well above their price. Brands are focusing heavily on optimisation, making under-20K phones more dependable than ever for everyday users, students, and even light creators.

Zero1 Winner: CMF Phone 2 Pro

The CMF Phone 2 Pro takes the crown this year by offering the most refined and complete budget experience. Powered by a well-optimised MediaTek Dimensity 7300 Pro chipset, it delivers consistently smooth day-to-day performance, stable thermals, and responsive multitasking without the stutters typically seen in this price bracket.

It comes with an AMOLED display that is bright, colour-accurate and well-tuned for outdoor visibility, a rarity under 20K. The 50MP telephoto camera, paired with a 50MP main camera and an 8MP ultra-wide camera, delivers clean, natural images with a balanced dynamic range. Low-light performance remains surprisingly reliable, thanks to CMF's software tuning.

With the CMF Phone 2 Pro, that design philosophy feels more mature. The exposed screws, textured rear plates and clean flat edges come together. It carries that modular iden-

CMF Phone 2 Pro
Price: ₹17,499



tity, but with a grown-up execution, so it's unmistakably CMF. The 5000mAh battery comfortably lasts a full day, and the lightweight, minimal Nothing OS adds to the overall polish.

Runner-up: Moto G96

The Moto G96 earns its runner-up spot with its clean software, strong performance tuning, and refreshingly reliable user experience. Backed by the Snapdragon 7s Gen 2 and LPDDR4X RAM, the phone feels consistently fluid in daily use, with Motorola's near-stock UI keeping things snappy and uncluttered.

The 144Hz FHD+ pOLED display is vibrant and responsive, making it great for scrolling, gaming and media. The 50MP primary camera leans toward punchier contrast and sharper output, a style many users will find visually appealing. Thermals remain controlled even during extended sessions, and the 5500mAh battery holds up comfortably for a full day.



Moto G96
Price: ₹17,999

Best Buy: Vivo T4x

The Vivo T4x wins our Best Buy award. Vivo has focused on fundamentals - smooth performance, a calibrated display, battery life and a reliable primary camera, resulting in a device that excels where it matters most.

Its IPS LCD panel is tuned for accurate colours, and the MediaTek Dimensity 7300 chipset ensures lag-free daily use. The 6500mAh battery offers endurance, making it ideal for power users or long travel. The 50MP primary camera isn't chasing extremes but gives consistent, natural results.

— Yashraj Verma | editor@digit.in



Vivo T4x
Price: ₹15,499